

GSI: Pia Deshpande



Time and Location

All sections will start at "Berkeley time," 10 minutes after the posted time

Section 104: Fridays, 8am – 9am, Social Sciences Building 151

Section 107: Fridays, 10am – 11am, Social Sciences Building 151

Office Hours: Fridays, 9am – 10am and 11am – 12pm, Social Sciences Building 151

Note: I have adapted this syllabus from Christian Caballero's Spring 2024 syllabus. All merits of this document should be attributed to him. All mistakes are my own.



Section Overview

Hi all — welcome to PS3! I'm excited to be your GSI. I love coding and stats (weird, I know!) and really enjoy teaching them both to other people. You will be first introduced to most concepts in Professor Dunning's lectures, and section will serve to reinforce what you know, clarify questions, and troubleshoot coding problems. **As a reminder: it is okay not to know things! We are all here to learn.**

Section will usually consist of mini-lectures of the previous week's key concepts, coding exercises, practice problems, and general discussion of the skills, concepts, and themes of the course, as well as different ways they might all apply in the world of politics and beyond. **Please bring your coding devices to section!**



Contact Information

It is my goal as your GSI to help you with anything even remotely related to the course! If you ever have a question, please feel free to email me at pia_deshpande@berkeley.edu.

Email Guidelines:

- I aim to respond within 48 hours during business hours (~9am-6pm)
- Please label your emails with **"PS3"** in the subject line
- Mark urgent emails as such for faster response
- If I don't respond within 48 hours, please kindly remind me

For general, non-personal questions, please post them on our **Ed discussion board**. You may receive a quicker reply here and other students may have the exact same question as you.



Office Hours

My office hours are set up to make it as easy as possible to attend, but if you need to meet outside of my posted office hours, please reach out to me and I will be happy to set up an alternative time/location. Oftentimes, students don't take advantage of office hours because they are unaware what office hours are even for. I don't want that to stop you!

Here are some examples of discussion topics for office hours:

- You are having trouble with a course concept and need help understanding it
- You are wondering if a research question you thought up would be a good fit for the course project
- You are trying to code up a question for a problem set and you need some guidance
- You want to write a thesis next year and wanted to ask questions about this
- You want to know what graduate school is like
- You want to practice going to office hours in a lower stake environment



Technology Resources

If there is an issue accessing technology at any point in the semester (or at your time at Berkeley), consider the following resources:

Student Technology Equity Program

Free long-term loans of laptops, headphones, and other hardware devices (GSIs receive priority)

Cost of Attendance Adjustment

Loan (sometimes grant) of \$3000 to purchase a computer every 3 years through financial aid

Student Helpdesk

Free drop-in tech support in Doe Library, Eshleman Hall, and Fannie Lou Hamer Resource Center

Email: sts-help@berkeley.edu | Phone: 510-642-HELP

Free Software

Visit software.berkeley.edu (<http://software.berkeley.edu>) and click "What am I eligible for?" to find over a dozen free software packages



Attendance Policy

As a reminder from the course syllabi, you are granted **1 unexcused absence**, no questions asked. Beyond this, every unexcused absence will incur a **20% penalty** from the 5% of your overall grade that section makes up.

Things come up and life happens. If you know you will not be able to make it to a section, please just email me ahead of time to let me know.

Collaboration Policy

Collaboration is vital to the learning experience in the classroom and we will be relying on it heavily. With that said, please remember that, for problem sets:

1. **Try problems independently first.** You should always spend some time trying to figure out the problems on your own before turning to others. This is both to keep a check on how well you understand the material, and because the initial stages of trying to crack a problem on your own are an important way on the path to understanding.
2. **Write your own answers from scratch.** You must write your own answers from scratch. For example, do not collaborate on joint answers that you then re-write in your own words. Copying/pasting answers from others is strictly prohibited and will be considered a violation of the academic honor code.

Additional Resources

DSP Accommodations

260 Cesar Chavez Student Center #4250, Lower Sproul Plaza

dsp.berkeley.edu (<https://dsp.berkeley.edu>)

[Academic Accommodations Hub](https://evcp.berkeley.edu/programs-resources/academic-accommodations-hub) (<https://evcp.berkeley.edu/programs-resources/academic-accommodations-hub>)

Student Learning Center

Cesar Chavez Student Center, Lower Sproul Plaza

slc.berkeley.edu/home (<https://slc.berkeley.edu/home>)

Counseling and Psychological Services

Tang Center, 2222 Bancroft Way

uhs.berkeley.edu/caps (<https://uhs.berkeley.edu/caps>)

Sexual Harassment and Confidentiality Policy

PATH to Care website: sa.berkeley.edu/dean/confidential-care-advocate
(<http://sa.berkeley.edu/dean/confidential-care-advocate>)

PATH to Care 24/7 Care Line: 510-643-2005

Important Notice: As UC employees, all course instructors, GSIs, and tutors are "Responsible Employees" and are required to report incidents of sexual violence, sexual harassment or other conduct prohibited by university policy to the Title IX officer. We cannot keep reports of sexual harassment or sexual violence confidential, but the Title IX

officer will consider requests for confidentiality. There are confidential resources available to you through UCB's PATH to Care Center, which serves survivors of sexual violence and sexual harassment.